

Mayan

The influence of Teotihuacán (see [here](#)) reached the Mayan people in the tropical lowlands of what is now Guatemala. Their civilization reached its peak around the sixth century CE, with over 50 independent states and more stone cities than any other pre-Columbian culture. These included vast complexes of terraced temple-pyramids and palaces built around large plazas.

With a population of about 45,000, the city of Tikal featured great plazas with many stone temples built on platforms, including wide staircases and painted stucco façades. The largest of these was the Temple of the Inscriptions (built c.700–800 CE) – a massive stone rectangle with a steep staircase leading up nine levels. The tall, narrow Temple of the Giant Jaguar, built c.730, rises in nine steep tiers of finely carved stone. Roof combs, or cresteria, crowned many Mayan pyramids. At Uxmal, a Mayan city whose name translates as ‘thrice built’, the Palace of the Governors (opposite, c.900) is a trio of wide, low buildings connected by triangular stone arches.

